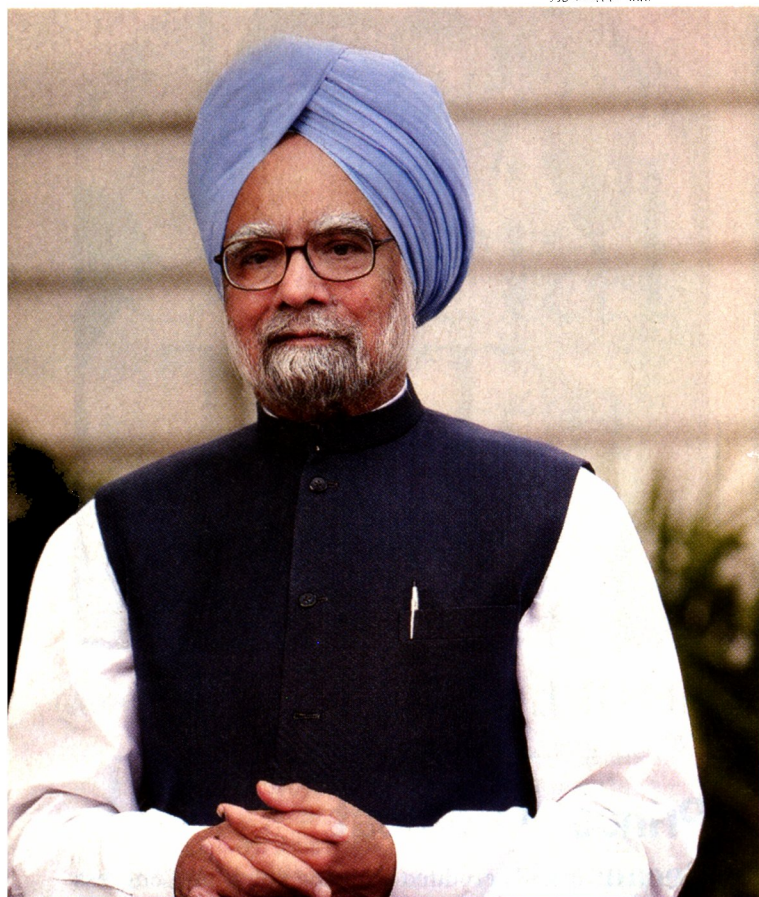




SOUND OF MUSIC Loves listening to his wife singing the Gurbaani.

POWER TOOL The prime ministerial signature is always penned with a silver Cross pen.

3

MANMOHAN SINGH

77, Prime Minister (3)

Quiet Effective

Because he is the first non-Gandhi prime minister to win a second term.

Becausethe Gandhis trust him implicitly.

Becausehis innate decency and sound economic credentials played a role in crafting the Congress win.

Becausehe wowed global leaders with India's panacea for the economic meltdown at the G-20 Summit on the financial crisis last April.

Political faux pas His eagerness to win everlasting peace with Pakistan resulted in the Sharm el-Sheikh goof-up. After the nuclear deal, a breakthrough with Pakistan is the next big must-do on his agenda.

The big question "*Kya sher bhi kabhi kulla karta hai* (does a lion wash his face?)", he told one of his aides when asked if he would like to freshen up before a press conference that had him blasting the BJP.

The reality check Still has his white Maruti 800 parked at Race Course Road.

Little known fact Is not tech-savvy. Does not own a computer. It was his wife, Gursharan, who mastered the TV remote much before he did.

His pet peeve L.K. Advani who ran an entire campaign calling him the weakest prime minister.

HEMAN CHAWLA/www.indiatodayimages.com

Mr Indispensable

Becausehe presides over Cabinet meetings in the absence of Prime Minister Manmohan Singh and is the leader of the Lok Sabha.

Becausewhen he cannot make it to a Cabinet meeting, Manmohan postpones it.

Becausehe is the CPJ's chief troubleshooter and heads over 18 govts.

Becauseonly he can get away with ticking off Mamata Banerjee at a Cabinet meeting.

POWER NUMBER 13. Even though he was offered 9 Janpath, chose to stay in the smaller 13 Talkatora Road house.

POETIC LICENCE Loves Victorian poetry. Robert Browning and Lord Byron are his favourites.

4

PRANAB MUKHERJEE

74, Finance Minister (5)

Becausehis socialist credentials give him credibility when he has to make capitalist moves such as the petrol price hike.

Did you know His all-time favourite movie is *Benji*.

The regret That he does not know Hindi. Says this is one of the reasons why he cannot become prime minister.

Matter of faith Believes in spirituality and cannot do without his daily puja.

